

Part 1

I want to reflect on the design of my smartwatch, a Galaxy Gear 2. When these watches came out, a large feature that drew people in was the rotating bezel. There is a large bezel going all the way around the screen. It is textured and clicks into certain spots, much like a rotary encoder. The two senses it plays to are touch and hearing, and it is an incredibly satisfying way to interact with the device.

The bezel is also very well used in the software. It can change the screens, and once on a screen, it can change settings and act like a slider. They even put in a way to use it as an unlock method. Much like a locker lock, you turn the dial, changing directions when you have the number you want. This makes the bezel feel like a real part of the interface rather than just a gimmick.

I am 6 feet tall and have rather large hands, so using such a small touchscreen can be a bit challenging. The bezel gives me another way to interact with the watch without having to precisely touch a small area of the screen. The physical feedback also makes it easy to understand what I am doing without constantly looking at the screen. I can feel the bezel move and hear the little clicks as I turn it.

I think the designers were very clever because this is a standard part of a watch. It is raised, protecting the screen from damage while also acting as an interface. The satisfying nature of the bezel also means it is used as often as possible and really avoids becoming a gimmick. It takes a small touchscreen and gives it real haptic feedback.

The little click the watch makes as you rotate the dial is subtle but elevates the experience. It removes some of the strange illusion people get that behind a smart device is unseen magic. When you interact with a touchscreen, you touch a flat piece of glass, and something happens digitally. With the bezel, there is a physical connection between what you are doing and what the device is doing. You can feel the dial move, hear it click, and then see the result on the screen. I think that combination of touch, hearing, and vision is what makes the bezel such a satisfying part of the watch.

Part 2

For the touch segment, I would say that the idea that touch is active resonated most with me. As I was saying before, touching the bezel lets the user feel a more active interaction than just using the screen. The screen is smooth, and except for the light coming out of it, it does not really change when it is touched. The bezel, however, gives resistance for a moment before snapping into its next position. The user can feel both the position of the bezel and the change in resistance as it moves. The watch literally pushes back for a moment. This makes the interaction feel more physical because I am not just telling the watch what to do; I am physically feeling it respond to me.

I also learned from the reading that sound is not the same as hearing, so I have been talking about it incorrectly in my previous reflection. The sound the watch makes is very sharp as the bezel settles into its new position. This really plays into the ideas in *The Senses* about sound being communication. I am telling the watch to move, and it is essentially responding, "I am in my new position." The sound also connects to the idea of sound being material. The sharpness of the click gives me an impression of precision and solid construction. It makes the interaction feel deliberate and well-made, which further elevates my experience of the watch.

Thinking about the sound this way also made me realize how strange and interesting even a tiny interaction can be. There is an inherent realization, at least for me, that I have just interacted with the physical universe. The small click of the bezel is created by vibrating particles around me, and those vibrations become sound waves that continue to move until they are eventually drowned out by other sounds. On a technical, physical-chemistry level, the interaction I made travels outward through the universe, impacting particles, if only by the tiniest amount. The reading made me think about the bezel not just as an interface, but as a physical interaction that exists beyond the screen and connects my digital experience back to the physical world.